MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 1

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the paragraph. The main idea is what the whole paragraph is about, in one sentence. The details are the facts that support it. Write the main idea in the top box and three supporting details below.

Bats Are Helpful

grades 2 to 3 · 64 words

Many people are afraid of bats, but bats help us every night. One small bat can eat hundreds of mosquitoes in an hour. Some bats drink from flowers and carry pollen from plant to plant, so the plants can make fruit. Fruit bats also drop seeds as they fly, and new trees grow where the seeds land. Farmers, gardeners and forests all need bats.

Main idea one sentence

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Test your main idea: does every detail in the paragraph tell you more about it? If one does not fit, your main idea may be too narrow.

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MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 1 ANSWER KEY

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Bats Are Helpful

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Main idea one sentence

Bats are helpful animals.

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

They eat hundreds of mosquitoes and other insects every night.

Detail 2

They carry pollen from flower to flower so plants can make fruit.

Detail 3

They drop seeds as they fly, and new trees grow.

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